Infobits

Nowadays media are available as contact plates, agar strips, media cassettes, contact slide and settle plates which are used for microbial air monitoring and compressed gas lines in food and beverage production plants. These media are also used for the enumeration of typical food contaminants such as coliforms, yeast and molds.

Colour coded MC-MEDIA pads are available for rapid and convenient microbial testing for *Escherichia coli*, yeast, mold, coliform and aerobes.

and plates are incubated at a specific temperature for a given period of time.

- Plates are incubated in an inverted manner.
- After incubation, the colonies are formed in a discrete pattern both on the surface of agar and also embedded within the medium.
- Pour plate can be also used to determine the number of cells in a population.(Figure 5.10)

Disadvantages of pour plate method

i) Loss of viability of heat sensitive organisms coming into contact with hot agar.

ii) Reduced growth of obligate aerobes in the depth of agar.

iii) Colonies embedded within the agar are much smaller than that of surface and may be confluent or invisible.



Basic five '**I**' steps one should follow in culturing micro organisms

a. **I**noculation
b. **I**ncubation
c. **I**solation
d. **I**nspection
e. **I**dentification

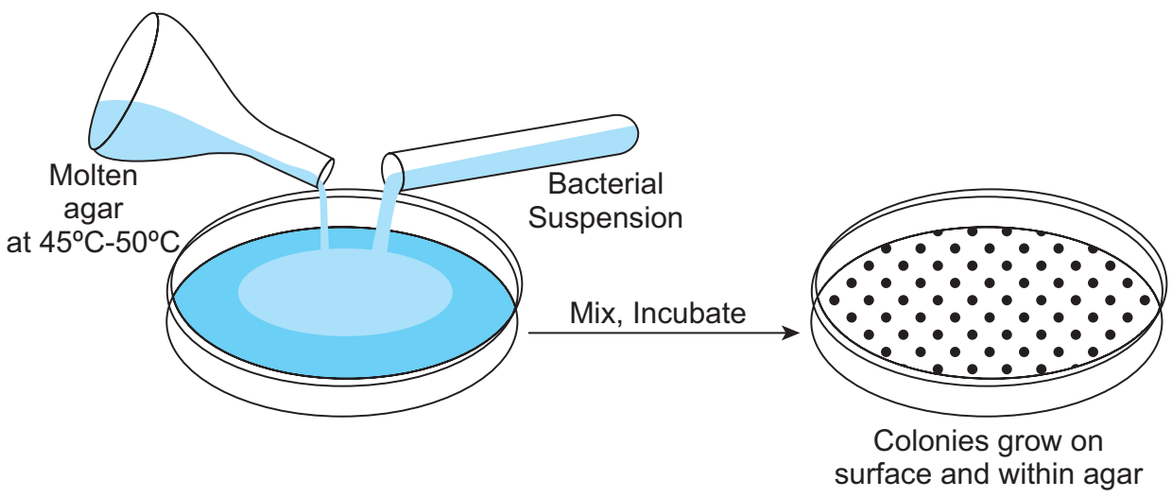


Figure 5.10: Pour plate method

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